Vegetation

Important trees are shown by special symbols. Trees, grasses and shrubs are all shown in green colour. Agricultural land is shown in yellow colour.

Land use

Land use includes the use of land under different categories like agriculture, pasture, barren land and forest area. Other land use categories could be mining, industry, trade, tourism, fishing or cattle rearing. It also informs us about the presence (location) of airports, railway stations, schools offices, trade centres, electric substations, etc. Sometimes, land use is directly mentioned, for example, brick kiln, limestone quarry, etc. At other times it has to be inferred.

Settlements

The size, shape, pattern site, position and function of settlements should be considered while interpreting a topographical sheet because all these aspects are interdependent.

Settlements could be dispersed or scattered, compact or nucleated type. They may be radial or linear in pattern. They are also studied under the following heads, based on their size and the activities the population is engaged in.

Permanent settlements are shown by solid squares and temporary ones in outlines of squares.

- **Rural settlements**: They can be compact, semi compact, dispersed or linear, etc.
- **Urban settlements**: It is the capital city, administrative town, trade centre, port town, religious or tourist station or a hill station.

The basic occupations that the people are probably engaged in, can be understood after the land use pattern and the type of settlement have been understood.

Transport and communication

The means of transport and communication being used can be identified from the presence of national and state highways, district and village roads, cart tracks, camel tracks, footpaths, railways, waterways, telephone and telegraph lines, post offices, etc.

Roads are not drawn true to scale. Metalled roads are shown by double lines, and unmetalled by broken double lines. Foot path shown by red dots and cart track by single broken lines. Different kinds of railways are shown by different signs.

11.6 Interpretation of selected topo sheet

Mirzapur and Varanasi District, U.P
OSM Sheet No G44Q12 63K/12

Introduction

The OSM Sheet No G44Q12 63K/12 (Figure 11.2) covers major part of Mirzapur District and partly Varanasi District of Uttar Pradesh. It is based on the survey of 1970-71 and was published in 1978. It carries the scale of 1: 50,000 and covers area about 440 km^2 extending from 25° 0'N latitude to 25° 15'N latitude and 82°30'E longitude to 82° 45'E longitude.

Relief

It has two distinct physiographic units: 1. The Ganga Plain and 2. Vindhyan Plateau.

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